



Tips & Tricks

Get the PID of a running process

You can check the PID of a running process/daemon by using the *pidof* command, as follows:

```
groot@linux-ygm3:~$ pidof program-name
```

For example, to check what the PID of *sshd* is on my system, I can use the following command:

```
groot@linux-ygm3:~$ pidof sshd
1863
```

—Gururaj Rao, raogrr@gmail.com

System reconfiguration on the next reboot

We can change the following configurations at one go when the system boots the next time: *passwd*, *netconfig*, *timeconfig*, *kbdconfig*, *authconfig* and *netsysv*. Use this command as the root:

```
sys: unconfig
```

...and reboot the system to reset these details.

—Vineeth T V, vnthtv@gmail.com

Using Vim as a MySQL pager

When using MySQL, you can set any pager you wish using the pager command:

```
mysql> pager less
PAGER set to 'less'
mysql> pager vim -
PAGER set to 'vim -'
```

Using Vim as your pager allows you to quickly export your query output into whatever format you want. After issuing the above command, you can see your query results displayed in Vim.

—Vishwanath Hariharan, vishi83@gmail.com

Broadcast a message on all terminals

You can broadcast your message to everyone who's logged on at all terminals by using the *wall* command. Now if you want to broadcast a message to restart the system in five minutes, then open a terminal and run the following command:

```
wall system is going to restart in 5 minutes...
```

The above message will be broadcast to all terminals.

—Anand Nayyar, anand_nayyar@yahoo.co.in

Simple Vim trick

Want to check the man page of a command, or use a system call directly from your Vim editor? Place your cursor on the keyword and hit *Shift+k*. This takes you to the man page or the command where your cursor was, if it exists. Once you are done reading, hit *q* followed by *Enter* to get back to the Vim editor.

—Purna Chandar, purnachandar.midi@oneconvergence.com

Translating characters into a particular case

I have struggled a lot while writing a shell script to compare some *if* conditions in order to do a string match due to case sensitivity issues. The easiest solution is to convert each character in the string by using the *tr* binary.

Converting lower case characters into upper case characters in a string:

```
echo "Something" | tr [:lower:] [:upper:]
```

Converting upper case characters into lower case characters in a string:

```
echo "Something" | tr [:upper:] [:lower:]
```

—M Sivakumar, it.siva@yahoo.com